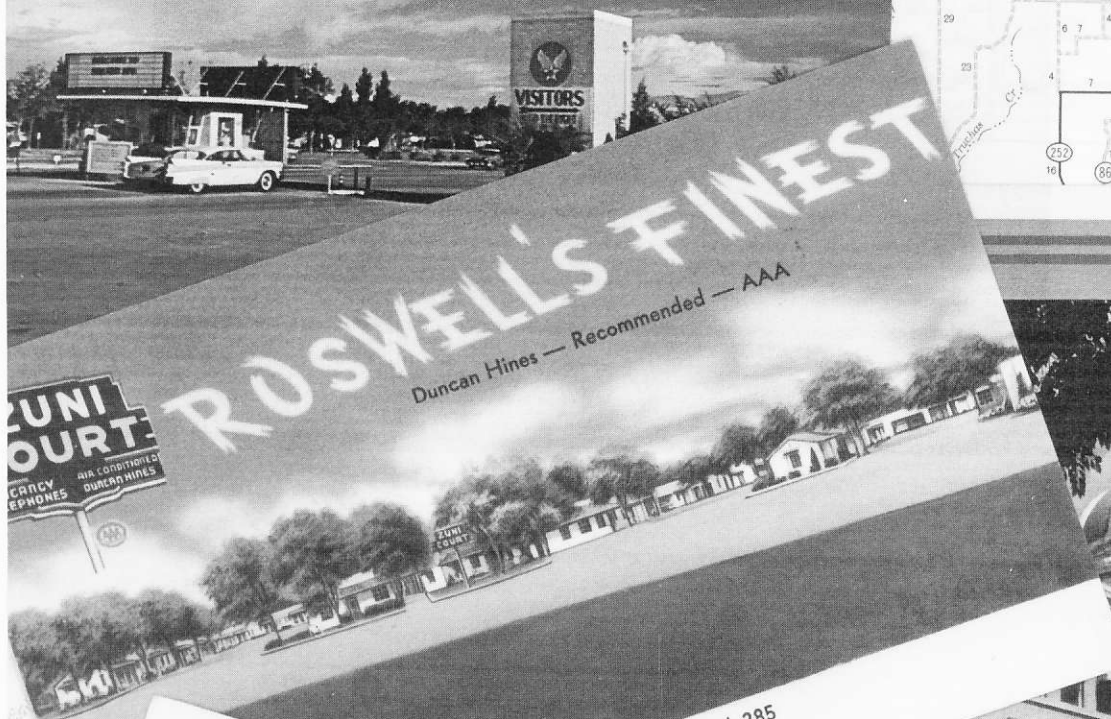


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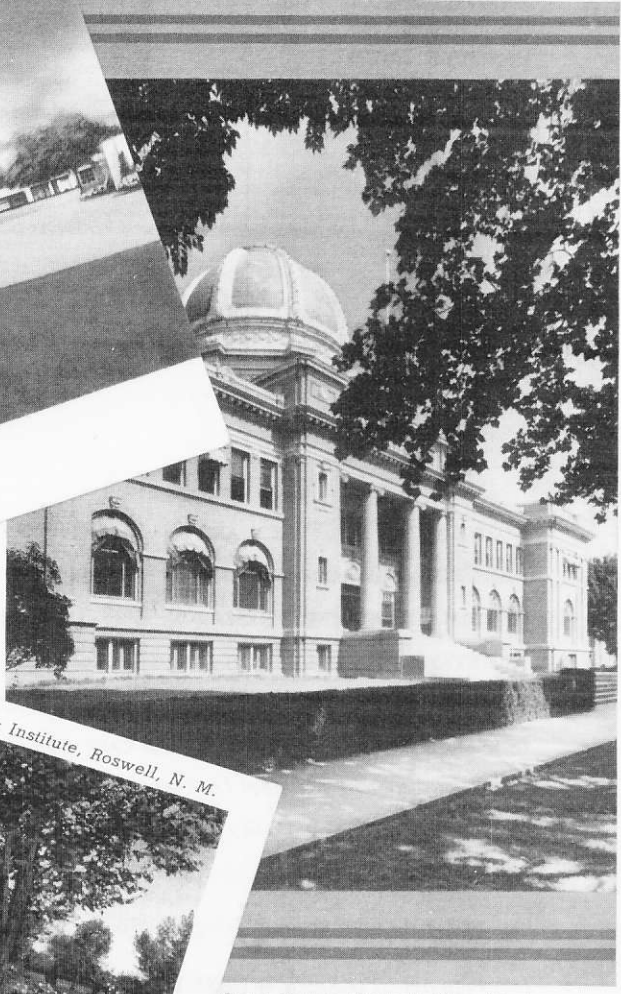


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ROSWELL

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Court House, Roswell, New Mexico

RESPONSES TO THE AIR FORCE'S
PROJECT MOGUL EXPLANATION

featuring:
Karl T. Pflock
Kevin D. Randle

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ROSWELL, THE AIR FORCE, AND US

BY KARL T. PFLOCK

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The *Report of Air Force Research Regarding the "Roswell Incident"*—or, as it is coming to be known in "honor" of its author, Col. Richard L. Weaver, the Weaver Report—is a victory for UFO research, U.S. Rep. Steven H. Schiff (R-New Mexico), and the American people. We have won the first battle in the struggle to pry loose Roswell-related information which the U.S. government has in its possession, a significant step toward full government accountability and public discourse of the whole truth about this important case.

How can he say that? more than a few readers are thinking. Quite simply, because it is true.

COVER STORIES, COVER-UP, AND PASSED BUCKS

In July 1947 the then Army Air Force concocted a cover story—or, more correctly, cover stories—to squelch press and public excitement engendered by the startling announcement from Roswell Army Air Field that it had captured one of the mysterious flying saucers. There was a mistake, the story went: the "saucer" was only a weather balloon and its radar target.

What was the Air Force covering up? There are those of us who have concluded from analysis of the currently available evidence that it was almost certainly a Top Secret Air Force research project called Mogul (of course there is more to the Roswell story—a little matter of strange bodies—about which more below). Others believe it was what the original announcement said it was, a crashed flying saucer.

Whatever the case may ultimately prove to be, the fact remains that the Air Force lied about Roswell in 1947. Given national-security considerations at the time, the lie was

justifiable—though the reported threats to radio stations and interference with a Teletype news transmission were probably unlawful and certainly unacceptable in a free society. Thus, while some may have been overzealous, the officials who made and carried out the decision to keep the matter under wraps were doing their duty. Nonetheless their "explanation" was lie, and it worked.

THE BUCK STOPS HERE

It was more than 30 years before the weather-balloon yarn began to unravel. Stanton T. Friedman's discovery of former Air Force intelligence officer Jesse A. Marcel in early 1978 started the process. There followed almost 17 years of Roswell research by several investigators, the present author among them. This work entailed and inspired numerous and ever more insistent citizen and Congressional requests to the Air Force and Department of Defense for the truth about Roswell. These were met with the established "we know nothing" response and buck-passing referrals to the Project Blue Book files in the National Archives.

After making scores of such referrals even the Air Force must have come to understand Blue Book records contained *nothing* about the case. (In a recent interview with Dayton, Ohio, television reporter Carl Day, former Blue Book chief Hector Quintanilla said the project had a substantial press-clipping file on Roswell. Curiously, this file never found its way to the National Archives.) Nonetheless, until the Office of the Secretary of Defense made the mistake of using this shopworn bit of bureaucratic sleight of hand with Rep. Schiff, the brush-off served its purpose. Then, encouraged by concerned constituents and the UFO-research community, Schiff pressed the issue. Ultimately he directed the General Accounting Office (GAO), Congress's investigative agency, to pursue an exhaustive audit of government records and ferret out what, if anything, they contain about what happened at Roswell and why. If relevant or potentially relevant records are found to be missing, Schiff has directed the GAO to seek to determine their disposition and the authority under which such actions were taken. As a key agency under the GAO microscope, the Air Force was left with little choice but to go at least through the motions of a serious records review and investigation. This was a victory for us.

Karl T. Pflock is a writer and independent UFO researcher. As a deputy assistant secretary of defense in the Reagan administration, he had the unenviable duty of managing the office's dealing with the GAO and Congress. Pflock is the author of Roswell in Perspective, an interim report on his continuing investigation of the Roswell incident. It is available from the Fund for UFO Research, Box 277, Mount Rainier, MD 20712.

OUT OF THE WILD BLUE YONDER

As it turns out, the Air Force did quite a bit more. It concluded officially that whatever Mac Brazel had stumbled upon that fateful day, it was not the wreckage of an aircraft or rocket of any type, American or foreign. Further, with the exception of Project Mogul, the Air Force concluded officially that the debris was not from any sort of experimental activity, classified or unclassified. Moreover, it found officially the debris did not result from a nuclear or nuclear-weapons delivery training accident. These findings match the results of painstaking work by several members of the UFO-research community and put the Air Force and us in agreement. Barring discovery of credible evidence to the contrary in the holdings of other agencies or elsewhere, such possible explanations are now off the Roswell table. Another victory for us.

With seeming credibility, the Weaver Report (p. 9) also states there are no *Air Force* Special Access (so-called Above Top Secret or Black) Programs (SAPs) "that pertain to extraterrestrial spacecraft/aliens" or "relating to the events at Roswell or the alleged technology that supposedly resulted therefrom," even in "some sort of passive 'caretaker status.'" (Weaver's responsibilities and findings were necessarily and properly confined to Air Force activities, past and present. Of course, it is up to the GAO to verify the Air Force's claims about its SAPs and to look into other "black" closets, both of which I understand it is doing.) This is consistent with the findings of those UFO researchers (including me) who believe the evidence demonstrates that though Roswell may have involved the recovery of the remains of an alien craft and its crew, there is not now or has there ever been a high-level, supersecret Roswell research and keep-the-lid-on project; see my "'Project Snafu' and the Real Secret of Roswell," in *Government Policy on UFO Information: Its Origins and Status* (Fund for UFO Research Paper #1, Richard Hall, editor, just published by FUFOR). A small victory for the MJ-12-is-a-hoax contingent.

The Air Force also established officially and unequivocally that what Brazel found could not have been an ordinary weather balloon. Attachment 9 to the Weaver Report is a March 9, 1994, memorandum from the Weather Directorate of the Deputy Chief of Staff of the Air Force; it states, "We did not find any records in the Air Force weather archives of a weather balloon crash near Roswell, New Mexico[,] from 20 June to 31 July 1947." Other attachments to the report support the conclusion that there was far too much debris to be accounted for by a mere weather observation device. Once again, the Air Force—no doubt much to its chagrin—finds itself in agreement with the findings of the UFO-research community, and the weather-balloon tale can no longer be floated as the truth. An important victory for us.

Thus there is no longer any doubt that Maj. Gen. Roger M. Ramey's "it's just a weather balloon" announcement was, at the very least, hasty. Combine the official Air Force

findings with the unequivocal testimony of the late Brig. Gen. Thomas J. DuBose, Ramey's chief of staff in July 1947, that "the weather balloon explanation for the material was a cover story to divert the attention of the press," and it is established beyond reasonable doubt that the Eighth Air Force commander's story was a deliberate untruth. In other words, *the Air Force has provided official confirmation that the tattered and torn official "explanation" for Roswell was a lie.* A big, important victory for us.

PROJECT MOGUL?

The Weaver Report concludes that "the material recovered near Roswell was . . . most likely from one of the Mogul balloons." I and other UFO researchers have independently arrived at the same conclusion. Weaver's report and its voluminous attachments provide substantial additional documentation and testimony which bolster this argument. Study of the more than 800 pages of Weaver Report attachments is essential to meaningful evaluation of the Air Force findings, including the clumsy attempts to sidestep addressing the reports of strange bodies at Roswell Army Air Field.

Of course, even with all the testimony and documentation we now have in hand about Mogul and its New Mexico activities in the late spring and early summer of 1947 (including documentation of the "missing" and most likely "culprit" flights), even with the remarkably Mogul-consistent testimony of not fewer than 15 Roswell-incident witnesses (14 firsthand), even with the seemingly supportive analysis of the photographs taken in Ramey's office (Weaver Report, pp. 20–21 and Attachment 33), we still do not have *proof positive* that Mogul is the answer to what was found in Brazil's debris field. (Yet to be found are the Mogul project-office files, which if they exist may contain the sought-after documents.) The case for Mogul, though substantial, is purely circumstantial and in some important respects anecdotal and dependent upon decades-old memories. But so, too, is the case for Brazel's find's being extraterrestrial-spacecraft wreckage, which is also anecdotal and far more tenuous than its earthly rival.

Though I now consider it most unlikely, perhaps the truth lies at some strange middle ground, as I suggested in my *Roswell in Perspective* (1994). As may be, wherever one may stand on the question of the debris field's origin, it cannot be gainsaid that the Air Force's prodigious research effort on Project Mogul has given the UFO-research community (and the GAO) a substantial body of material to study in our quest for the real answer, even if ultimately the best we can do is arrive at a high probability the answer is—or is not—Mogul. Still another victory for us.

BODIES? WHAT BODIES?

The Air Force's all-out effort on Mogul contrasts starkly with its less than half-hearted attempt to get at the truth about the bodies and, speaking for the Air Force, Col. Weaver's

snide and sarcastic attempt to dismiss the issue. At the outset of its research, the Air Force appears to have taken seriously both the debris field and the strange bodies and associated wreckage reported to have been at Roswell AAF and flown out a day or two later. This is reflected in early (March 1, 1994) requests from Weaver's office to various Air Force components and staff organizations for information concerning aircraft accidents and other mishaps which could have involved fatalities, though it is important to note there is no indication anything specific to nonhuman remains was ever pursued (see, for example, Weaver Report Attachments 7 and 8). Ultimately, this line of inquiry simply fizzled out (see Attachment 28, item e), and we are handed an unsupported, take-our-word-for-it denial of any Air Force involvement in "an 'alien' body recovery" (Weaver Report, p. 22). Why?

At a minimum, and to my mind most likely, the Air Force simply decided Mogul was good enough for government work, that it could be passed off as the all-encompassing explanation for Roswell, the product of a good-faith effort to answer the Congressional mail. Besides, writes Col. Weaver (p. 22 of his report), "there were no 'alien' passengers" on Mogul flights, and "pro-UFO groups who [*sic*] espouse the alien bodies theories cannot even agree among themselves as to what, how many, and where such bodies were supposedly recovered."

Further, he writes, "some of these claims have been shown to be hoaxes, even by other UFO researchers [wonder of wonders!]," and some have been made by "people using pseudonyms or who otherwise do not want to be publicly identified." Moreover, "many of the persons making the biggest claims of 'alien bodies' make their living from the 'Roswell Incident.'" Weaver concludes his smart-aleck dismissal of the bodies by condescendingly allowing as how "persons who have come forward and provided their names and made claims, may have, in good faith but in the 'fog of time' misinterpreted past events." I am sure Glenn Dennis appreciates this pat on the back.

SEMPER NON SEQUITUR

I doubt it has been lost on *IUR* readers that each and every one of the above "reasons" for effectively ignoring the bodies issue is a non sequitur. Weave and spin as he will, Weaver cannot escape the fact that he and the Air Force failed to do their duties in responding to Congressional direction. Weaver and his research team were supposed to have conducted a no-stone-unturned search for any and all Roswell-related documents—including those that may have dealt with the bodies—in the Air Force's possession or under its jurisdiction or control. They did not do so, and in their arrogance they attempt to justify it with the sorts of excuses most of us gave up in grade school.

In an odd way this Air Force failure is another victory for us. It highlights for priority consideration a very important question among the many the GAO will pursue as it

independently checks the Air Force claims and findings—a process which, having been on the receiving end of more than one such probe, I know it will execute with excruciating thoroughness.

"Weaver cannot escape the fact that he and the Air Force failed to do their duties in responding to Congressional direction."

THE AIR FORCE BOMBS

According to established practice, the Weaver Report and its supporting attachments were supposed to have been compiled only as "raw material" for consideration by the GAO in its continuing investigation. With careless disregard for Congressional courtesy, clear contempt for the concerned citizens who under the Constitution are its masters, and a breathtaking neglect of its own long-term interest, the Air Force also chose to use its report in a preemptive strike designed to (1) get the Air Force take on Roswell out to the media and public independent of findings and conclusions by the GAO and Rep. Schiff, and many months before the GAO report can be completed and publicly released; (2) establish the Air Force spin as the definitive answer in the minds of the media and public and convince them (and perhaps even the GAO and Schiff) that there is nothing more of any importance to be learned; (3) fool a large segment of the public, especially those with a strong interest in UFOs, into thinking the Weaver Report is *the* Roswell report asked for by Rep. Schiff; and (4) give the Air Force a Roswell-specific, Condon Report-style excuse to use in responding to inquiries from those who did not get the word (Weaver, p. 22: "It is recommended that this document serve as the final Air Force report related to the Roswell matter, for the GAO, or any other inquiries"). The follow-up strike in this strategy will come soon, when the Government Printing Office publishes the Weaver Report for public sale.

Though the Air Force succeeded in beating the GAO and Congress to the punch, it has had little success in coopting the media. The *New York Times* made itself available as an Air Force propaganda organ, and the Associated Press uncritically reproduced the Air Force press release with a few embellishments. But these lines from editorials in major New Mexico newspapers well sum up the overwhelming reaction of the thoughtful media nationwide: "In the final analysis, all the Air Force really gave up in response to Schiff's request is confirmation that they lied back in 1947 about what really happened" (*Albuquerque Journal*). "The Air Force for decades insisted it had no additional information about the matter. Then suddenly it comes up

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THE PROJECT MOGUL FLIGHTS AND ROSWELL

BY KEVIN D. RANDLE

The United States Air Force, on September 8, 1994, announced they had reviewed their records and determined that the debris found by Mac Brazel on his ranch northwest of Roswell was the remains of a balloon and array train from Project Mogul. Project Mogul was a top-secret postwar balloon project designed to monitor Soviet nuclear tests. The Air Force suspects, as explained by Mark Rodeghier and Mark Chesney (September/October *IUR*), that it was balloon Flight 4 of Project Mogul that was the source of the debris. They do not, though, have any records to prove this supposition. Karl Pflock, in his report *Roswell in Perspective*, agrees that it was a Project Mogul balloon, but suggests that the debris came from Flight 9 instead. As with the Air Force's hypothesis, there is no compelling documentation to support that claim either.

What do we know about the Mogul balloon flights? I will attempt to provide an answer to that question by drawing on several available sources. There is now a large number of formerly classified documents available, and many people who worked on the project have been located and interviewed, in some cases by Air Force investigators. I will use this available evidence, including official flight records, to consider how likely it is that a Project Mogul balloon might have been the source of some of the debris recovered near Roswell.

Long before the Air Force began its investigation, UFO investigators had been aware of Project Mogul and the theory that a balloon from the project might have caused the Roswell event. For example, when Don Schmitt and I were writing our second book, *The Truth About the UFO Crash at Roswell*, we found documentation about a few Mogul flights, specifically for Flights 8, 10, and 11, among others. In our book, we wrote: "On July 3 cluster-balloon launch Number Eight was made. The balloon was not recovered, but it was spotted down in the Tularosa Valley just a few miles northwest of Alamogordo. There is no record of a Number Nine launching, but Number Ten took place on July 5. Though not recovered, again because of the terrain, it was reported to be down northeast of Albuquerque." This infor-

mation was contained in a report titled "Analysis of Project 'Grudge' Reported Incidents" and dated April 18, 1949. It was part of a huge report in the Project Blue Book files, prepared by then Captain A. C. Trakowski, one of the military officers attached to Project Mogul.

Pflock, in his discussion of Project Mogul, writes, "No information is available for the next numbered launch, Flight 9, which is missing from all Mogul documentation I have gathered to date. Both [Dr. C. B.] Moore and [Colonel A. C.] Trakowski have told me they recall nothing about it. However, Moore remembers several flights were 'classified out' of the NYU Project 93 reports and reports on subsequent balloon programs in which he was involved. It appears that Flight 9 was one of those."

Some documents concerning Flight 9, however, have now been located. It wasn't "classified out" as Pflock suggested because the flight was not tracked and nothing of scientific importance was learned by the flight. The evidence for that statement comes from the diary of Dr. Albert Crary, apparently the only written record for this balloon launch. Using the diary, Dr. Moore was able to recall what happened to balloon Flight 9.

THE CRITICAL FLIGHTS

Project Mogul Flight 8 was launched on Thursday morning, July 3, in conjunction with a V-2 rocket firing. Crary wrote: "On Thursday morning 3 July, a cluster of GM plastic balloons sent up for V2 recording but V2 was not fired. No shots fired. Balloons up for some time. No recording at Roswell . . . [?] Pibal showed no W winds. Balloons picked up by radar W S . . . [?] and hunted by Maryals [?] C-45. Located on Tularosa Range by air." According to other documentation, Flight 8 was found down in the Tularosa valley northwest of Alamogordo. The terrain was too rough for them to recover the equipment, but the debris was located.

This confirms the information reported in our book, what Dr. Moore has previously stated, and the details are also consistent with what Pflock has written in his report about this flight.

A little additional data might be helpful here. The early morning July 3 launch of the V-2 was postponed for some

Kevin D. Randle, an *IUR* contributing editor, is coauthor of *The Truth About the UFO Crash at Roswell* (1994).

reason, but the balloons were launched prior to the postponement. The data gathered by Flight 8, though, were considered to be of scientific value.

Project Mogul Flight 9 was scheduled to accompany the next launch of the V-2, which was quickly rescheduled for 7:30 that evening. Unfortunately, an accident occurred on the missile pad injuring several people, some seriously, and, as a consequence, the V-2 launch was canceled. Newspapers around the country carried the report of the accident. According to Crary's diary, "At the last minute before the balloon went up, V2 was called off . . . account accident at White Sands." Newspaper reports and statements by the commander at White Sands, Colonel Turner, have corroborated this.

Crary writes of Flight 9, the second launch on July 3: "Sent up cluster balloons with dummy load." That is all that he says about it, and apparently the only written record of it. Dr. Moore added to the detail, telling me that the balloons were stripped of their equipment, but the project engineers couldn't put the helium back into the bottles. The majority of the balloons were not the new polyethylene balloons but regular neoprene rubber. Helium leaked slowly from them. Because of that, they released the balloons, but nothing of value was learned from the flight.

All the equipment, balloons and records had been tagged for Flight 9. Because of that, the numbers weren't reused. The balloons were launched, but, according to Dr. Moore, they weren't tracked. The Watson Lab people in charge of operations had already been on duty from early

morning, and they suspended operations for the night. There is no record of the recovery of the balloons from Flight 9, and, in fact, no one knows what happened to them. Any suggestion about their fate is pure speculation.

Project Mogul Flight 10 was launched at 5:01 a.m. MST on July 5, and was last recorded over Pueblo, Colorado. There is no record of it being recovered. Trakowski's report

"... there is no hard evidence for Pflock's Mogul theory that Flight 9 was the source of the debris."

places this balloon down northeast of Albuquerque (Pueblo is northeast of Albuquerque), but we take the additional information from Technical Report No. 1 of New York University, the organization working with Watson Laboratories to engineer Project Mogul.

With the data above we can safely eliminate both Flights 8 and 10 as sources of the Roswell debris. The balloons were either seen on the ground or recorded electronically in locations that would exclude them from landing on the Brazel site.

That leaves Flight 9. But the evidence from Crary's diary, from the documentation, and the testimony from Dr. Moore, suggests that what fell on the Brazel ranch was not that flight, either.

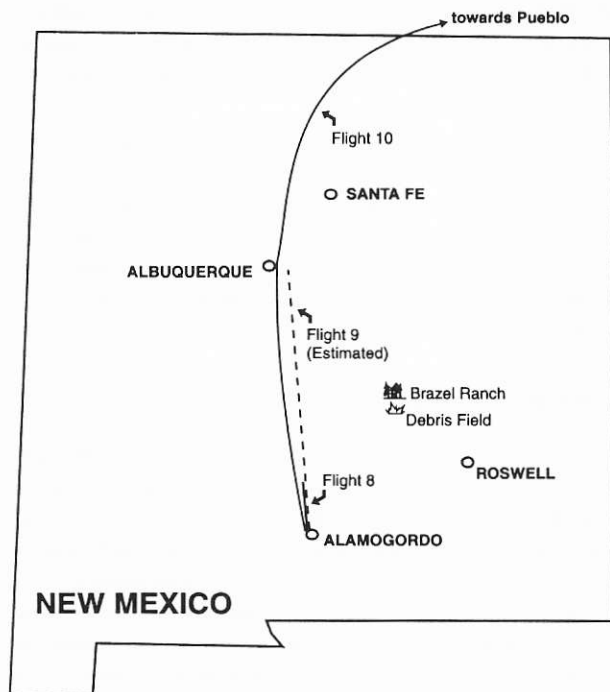
In fact, Dr. Moore told me that he didn't believe that a Mogul balloon was responsible for the debris field. Now, to be fair and accurate, what he was saying was that he didn't believe it was any of the polyethylene balloons or any part of the Flight 9 launch on July 3 that caused the debris. Instead, he believes that it was the neoprene rubber balloon arrays launched on June 4, 1947, that were responsible.

In this he agrees with the Air Force, which suggested in its report that Project Mogul Flight 4, launched in early June, was the source of the Roswell debris. This is unlikely for many reasons, not the least of which is that neoprene balloons, when exposed to sunlight, rapidly deteriorate and darken, yet the debris photographed in Brg. General Ramey's office in Fort Worth was intact and shiny. For this and many other reasons, Flight 4 can be excluded as the cause of the debris.

MOGUL FLIGHT CHARACTERISTICS

Project Mogul test flights did not remain in the air for days and days. This fact is crucial because it means that a Mogul balloon's flight path can be reconstructed by reviewing data on winds aloft for a relatively brief period (this is especially true because these flights attempted to remain at constant altitudes to facilitate the acoustic detection of nuclear detonations).

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Data on Flights 8 and 10 are based on Air Force and Project Mogul records. Data on Flight 9 are based on Dr. Crary's diary. It is likely that Flight 9 came nowhere near the debris field on the Brazel ranch.

AUSTRALIAN ABDUCTION RESEARCH

1993–1994

BY KEITH BASTERFIELD

It has been some five years now since I first wrote for *IUR* on the abduction phenomenon in Australia (July/August 1989 issue). This is the fourth in a series of *IUR* articles in which I have reported on the details of Australian abduction accounts, responses to overseas abductions by the local mass media, and research efforts by Australian colleagues and me.

MASS MEDIA

Until recently, relatively little material reached the general population. This state of affairs, however, has started to change.

First, David M. Jacobs's *Secret Life* arrived in Australia in 1992, generating several television programs over the following months, mainly on talk shows. The ones I saw did not treat the subject seriously and did not allow Jacobs time to either report on his data or elaborate on his findings.

Our national Channel 7 network started showing a program called *The Extraordinary* in March 1993. Its format is similar to that of the U.S.-based shows *Sightings* and *Unsolved Mysteries*. Early in its run it carried an abduction case from Perth, Western Australia.

A man whom the show called Andrew was lying in bed on February 4, 1992, feeling restless. Eventually he fell asleep. On awakening he found himself in a place he recognized as being the parking lot of a basketball stadium some 50 kilometers from his house. He experienced a white flash, and suddenly he was inside the stadium, in the midst of a crowd of fellow human beings. There were as well other beings who took on a human form. Andrew sensed that one of these latter beings was draining his thoughts. After another flash of brilliant white light Andrew woke up in his own bed. It was 2:15 a.m.

On March 4 he woke up paralyzed at 2:30 a.m. He saw a tall, misty blue being, 120–35 centimeters tall, guiding his son down the hallway. The figure vanished in a flash of white light. His paralysis gone, Andrew went to check on the boy,

who lay in bed looking pale and shaken.

Not long afterwards, as the family was eating a dinner of lamb roast, the son cleared his throat of an irritation and coughed up a tiny metal object.

Extraordinary's producers had this object analyzed at Curtin University in Perth. The university concluded that the object was most likely a computer component manufactured in Sweden. Unfortunately, after this airing the case faded into obscurity, and practically nothing more has been heard of it.

The film *Fire in the Sky* came to Australia in May 1993, and Travis Walton and Mike Rogers appeared on a number of television shows to promote it. The showing I attended at a local suburban cinema, shortly after the film opened, was poorly attended.

John E. Mack's book *Abduction* came on the scene in mid-1994, accompanied by interviews on current-affairs programs such as *60 Minutes*. Most treatments emphasized Mack's academic qualifications and indicated they lent credibility to the subject.

Interestingly, the abduction materials being absorbed into Australian popular culture are all U.S.-generated. Few Australians are aware of abduction events and research from the United Kingdom or Europe. For example, America's *Sightings*, which has been shown here during prime time, has featured several abduction-related stories, including one on "mass abductions."

SUPPORT GROUPS

Abductee support groups are a relatively recent phenomenon in Australia. Peter Khoury and Jaimie Leonarder initiated one such group in Sydney in April 1993. The UFO Experience Support Association, Inc., is essentially a non-profit group which aims to help witnesses and experiencers of UFO events cope with and understand their encounters.

From personal experience Khoury says he knows the confusion, isolation, fear, and ridicule which can result from an event or series of events. Thus the support group was formed to lend an ear, to listen but not to judge, and to extend compassion and understanding to those who need it. If an individual wishes, he or she can be referred to a qualified professional for psychological or medical assistance.

Keith Basterfield, a frequent contributor to IUR, is an associate of the UFO Research Australia network as well as a founder of the Australian UFO Abduction Study Center (GPO Box 1894, Adelaide, South Australia 5001).

A Melbourne woman known only as Brenda formed Victoria's UFO Experiencers Support Group in June 1993. Brenda had found no one with whom she could discuss her experiences. By August of this year, when I visited Melbourne, the group numbered eight to 10 individuals.

In mid-1994, following the visit to Adelaide, where I live, of another Victorian close-encounter witness, a number of South Australian experiencers came together to form a support group.

A fourth state, Queensland, also became host to another support group during this period, following a visit to Australia by Budd Hopkins.

All four groups have similar aims and maintain links with the more conventionally established UFO-research groups.

HEALTH PROFESSIONALS

The number of mainstream health professionals with a serious interest in this area remains low. My current count is only nine who have come forward in Brisbane, Sydney, Melbourne, and Adelaide, four of our capital cities.

NEW AGE

Concern has been expressed in some quarters here about the presence of New Age-oriented therapists who are now working with abductees. Researchers are concerned that abductees may pick up a New Age philosophy and bring such matters as "past-life" stories into their close-encounter narratives. Such therapists, needless to say, are not traditional mainstream health professionals. Nonetheless they are attracting a growing popular following. At the same time I have come upon a few abductees who themselves are now New Age therapists.

One is a woman named Linda, who contacted me in July of this year. Linda is now a "natural therapist" practicing therapeutic massage and teaching "self-growth." She herself had recently undergone a "miofacial" massage—apparently a deep facial massage which is said to bring up painful events from the past. It is said to work on the principle that memory resides at cellular level in the body and can be released to conscious level.

In the two weeks before she spoke with me, she had experienced intense anger as if she had been, in her words, "messed around with." All through her life she experienced an unnatural fear. Eventually she pieced together a story about two groups of aliens which started visiting her when she was in college. One was experimenting on her for some purpose. Another group of beings came along to help her.

TWO IMPORTANT CASES

In a paper titled "Invisibility and the UFO Abduction Phenomenon" in MUFON's 1993 symposium proceedings, Budd Hopkins reported on an Australian case which he had

investigated while here on a lecture tour. A Mrs. Washburn produced four photographs which should have included the family but did not—as if the family were in fact invisible.

The couple and their two children had been at a Brisbane, Queensland, playground. Under hypnotic regression by Hopkins, Mrs. Washburn related that she had been taken inside an object where several small beings were present. They led her two sons away, and she was subjected to a gynecological examination.

Next Mr. Washburn, who also proved to be a good subject, was regressed. He spoke of seeing a "ball" take his family away.

At some stage during the time at the playground, the Washburns took photographs of themselves and their sons. Yet they did not appear in these pictures when they were developed.

In Hopkins's view all four family members became invisible to everyone present at the site. The UFO and its accompanying "balls" also could not be seen by others.

On the night of August 7–8, 1993, an incident occurred near Belgrave, Victoria. It involved at least five persons in two separate motor vehicles. Both parties have been located and interviewed. The episode appears to be an independently witnessed CE3. My colleague Bill Chalker reported on it recently in these pages; see his "An Extraordinary Encounter in the Dandenong Foothills," September/October *IUR*.

THE AUSTRALIAN CENTER

Australia now has UFO researchers, health professionals, support groups, and alternative therapists talking with abduction experiencers. With this diverse range of approaches evident, and in view of the long distances that separate and isolate us here in Australia, I decided this year that it was time to put together a network through which all of these individuals could communicate. Therefore this past April I formed the Australian UFO Abduction Study Center. Its network now comprises 40 individuals. Its aims are these:

1. To act as an initial contact point for individuals who believe they have interacted with the UFO-abduction phenomenon.
2. To act as an information and referral service for these individuals and other interested persons.
3. To encourage research into the UFO-abduction phenomenon.

Strategies to achieve these aims are:

1. To make the well-being of the individual first priority; to refer individuals, if they wish, to qualified researchers and health professionals; and to promote the existence of the Center.
2. To produce and distribute a networking newsletter; to maintain an extensive book and journal collection on the subject; to interact with overseas abduction researchers.

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THE EYES HAVE IT

BY GEOFF OLSON

A particularly powerful component of the encounter experience is the confrontation with the eyes of purported alien entities. Among individuals claiming alien encounters, according to a MUFON survey, a third are said to involve entities that are small, thin, with bulbous heads and large, wrap-around black eyes. It is primarily among these latter cases that we hear reference to the uncanny quality of the entities' eyes, with the experiencer's sense of psychic invasion and loss of control.

Correlated with the large-eye entities is the experience of so-called screen memories, in which an out-of-place animal appears just prior to an encounter or abduction experience. The animal reportedly watches from a short distance, in an odd or unnerving manner. If the creature appears at night, the person may awaken to see it staring in through a window or discover it inside his or her room. Reports are made of cats, deer, wolves, and other animals—and, quite often, owls.

An example of this kind of report is one I heard from a woman in her mid-30s. When shown a visual inventory of dream images which another researcher and I had prepared, she immediately indicated the picture of an owl and asked in a surprised manner why we had included it among the mostly mundane images in the inventory. She also indicated that as a young girl she had been alarmed on several occasions by a set of eyes staring in at her from outside her bedroom window. Her mother had tried to calm her, telling her on these occasions that it was just a cat. Her bedroom was on the second floor of the house, with no balcony or supporting structure outside.

The scoffer will respond that reports like these are only "anecdotal"—the favorite term of disparagement for those in the thrall of scientism. But to be fair to the opposition, one can't rule out media contamination as contributing to these stories, through a conduit of confabulation or some other process. Nevertheless the consistency of these stories, plus their association with abduction lore, is genuinely problematic. Owl accounts in particular seem to erupt with maddening frequency in abduction accounts.

John E. Mack found similar patterns in his own inves-

tigations and determined that the screen-memory animal is sometimes one that has had some previous emotional significance in the experiencer's life. One of his patients, a woman who had raised horses when she was young, had a white horse appear before her prior to her abduction experiences.

I'm not concerned here with the phenomenological reality of the animals, whether they are intentionally generated to cover far more traumatic material (whatever that may be) or are images or entities externally generated by some alien intelligence. What impresses me is how the imagery relation to eyes segues so seamlessly from that of owls, cats, or some other creature to that of the standard bug-eyed alien. If abductions constitute a genuine phenomenon in the physical world, it may tell us something about how this alien intelligence is trying to communicate with us. If abductions are not physical events, then there is something almost equally bizarre going on with human consciousness.

SCREEN MEMORIES

The debunker's position would be that the screen-memory material involving visions of animals has already been widely disseminated through Budd Hopkins's *Intruders* (1987) and Whitley Strieber's *Communion* (1987), two books that have ended up on the shelves of abductees and researchers alike. The Klass-conscious types would say it's all simply a case of fantasy-prone persons who have soaked up this science-fiction stuff like a sponge, ready to empty it all out into the bucket of hypnotic regression. The argument is perhaps conceivable for contemporary abduction accounts, but it becomes less plausible the farther one goes back. Some other explanation must be entertained in the absence of media contamination.

Consider, for example, the granddaddy of abduction accounts, the Barney and Betty Hill case. One can't possibly blame the Fox network or Steven Spielberg for elements in their account that follow no science-fiction narrative whatever. There is material in John G. Fuller's book on the case, *The Interrupted Journey* (1966), that seemed at the time to be only nonsensical artifacts of the hypnotic regression—but in fact take on much greater significance with a retrospective distance of three decades.

In Fuller's book we read of Barney's attempting to

Geoff Olson, a writer and ufologist, lives in Vancouver, British Columbia.

describe an ineffable juncture in his abduction narrative. After pulling to the side of the road, to get a better view of the craft ahead with binoculars, Barney becomes unnerved to see figures moving in portholes on the craft. He has to pull the binoculars away from his eyes, away from the gaze of the figures; "otherwise I'll just stand there." Under hypnosis Barney is unnerved by the appearance of the figures: "His eyes! I've never seen eyes like that before." He gets back into the car with Betty and says, "Oh, those eyes! They're in my brain!"

Soon after this the figures appear on the road ahead, and Barney says with awe, "Oh, oh, the eyes are there. Always the eyes are there. And they're telling me I don't have to be afraid." But Barney is puzzled. The figures aren't talking to him, but their eyes seem to be communicating in a seemingly disembodied fashion: "Oh—the eyes don't have a body. They're just eyes." Then, according to Fuller's notes, Barney speaks with tremendous relief. "I know. I know. The, that's what it's got to be. It's a wildcat. A wildcat up a tree." Barney decides it's like the Cheshire Cat in *Alice in Wonderland* and there's nothing to be afraid of. But all he sees are eyes, and perhaps they have this disembodied feel at this point because "they're just up close to me, pressing against my eyes."

So here, in this early abduction account, we have elements highly suggestive both of a screen memory of a catlike quality and of what David M. Jacobs would later call the "mind-scan" procedure. For skeptics to rejoin that later, more full-blown abduction accounts with these elements were predicated on these brief, confused passages—well, it's a flimsy argument at best. As folklorist Thomas E. Bullard has indicated, it is these thematic elements—minor themes that keep cropping up in the grand fugue of UFO-abduction accounts—that demand a much better accounting than they have received so far.

OLD HAG

The theme of nonhuman entities with irresistible staring eyes turns up in another context, in a phenomenon that may be cousin to abduction lore. In *The Terror That Comes in the Night* (1982) David J. Hufford analyzed the experiential foundation of the "Old Hag." This is the term used among the people of Newfoundland to describe a nocturnal encounter with some terrifying supernatural force. As Hufford looked deeper into the phenomenon, he discovered that the Old Hag tradition was not limited to the eastern coast of Canada but was reported elsewhere across North America. It has gone largely unreported, Hufford felt, because it has no name in either common parlance or the psychological literature, though it is now thought that up to six percent of the population has experienced it.

Briefly, the Old Hag experience typically involves waking in the middle of the night and sensing a presence in the room. Footsteps are often heard, and the subject feels paralyzed at the onset, unable to move or cry out. A figure

may or may not be seen, though the subject may feel something breathing on his or her neck, feel a pressure on the chest, and smell a pungent odor. When seen, the figure can be almost any size or shape (in the Newfoundland tradition it was sometimes an evil-looking crone), anything from an amorphous gaseous white shape to an apelike creature.

The experience seems similar to hypnopompic and hypnagogic states (imagery that precedes the onset of sleep or follows upon waking), but it seems to be a much more overt phenomenon, experienced in full consciousness. Persons interviewed for Hufford's book commented in several instances about the uncanny quality of the figures' eyes: "It approached toward the bed and as I said it—it kind of stood over me with a glare. That's—that's really why I said it was evil. . . . [A]s I recall I couldn't make out a face per se, but I could see two holes that would—that would seem to be the eyes. But they were dark too." Another account: "The face wasn't a clear face, but what it did have—and what scared me and made me not want to move—was two very dark eyes. You know, piercing eyes looking at me. . . . I could make out distinct features of the eyes. . . . Very dark eyes. They were piercing. They were just looking at me. It wasn't just like two dots. They were eyes and it sent a chill up my spine."

One can easily find encounter cases that span the continuum between Hufford's ghostly nighttime experiences and the more overtly extraterrestrial content of modern abduction accounts. The commonalities between the two phenomena suggest that they may have more than a surface similarity and are perhaps two species of a single genus of experience. One interpretation is that the extraterrestrial archetype is mapped onto the experientially convincing but internally generated Old Hag phenomenon. This would be supported by Hufford's own interviews with individuals who were seen by other persons during their "hagging." They were observed staring straight ahead in horror while the experience played out; yet onlookers saw nothing else. In the famous Maureen Puddy abduction case (see Keith Basterfield's "Present at the Abduction," May/June 1992 *IUR*), a woman experienced an abduction while sitting behind the wheel of a car; two investigators looked on in astonishment, seeing nothing that could account for her fear. But to show how problematic any reductionist interpretation can be, Hufford also included a case in his book where the peripheral phenomena associated with the Old Hag experience—footsteps heard, beds shaking up and down, disembodied voices—were experienced by multiple witnesses.

EYE TO EYE

So what can we learn from the screen memories involving staring animals, Hufford's staring Hags, and the mind-scanning grays?

Princeton psychologist Julian Jaynes has a theory that may provide oblique assistance in working through this puzzle. In creatures below humans, Jaynes asserts, eye-to-

eye contact is important in establish dominance hierarchies, with the submissive animal "turning away grinning in most primate species." In humans, however, eye-to-eye contact has taken on a much more important, and nuanced, dimension. When an infant is addressed by its mother, it looks to her eyes, not her lips. Says Jaynes, "[T]he development of such eye-to-eye contact into authority relationships and love relationships is an exceedingly important trajectory that has yet to be traced. It is sufficient here merely to suggest that you are more likely to feel a superior's authority when you and he are starting straight into each other's eyes. There is a kind of stress, and unresolvedness about the experience, and withal something of a diminution of consciousness."

Jaynes developed the idea, outlined in his 1977 book *The Origin of Consciousness in the Breakdown of the Bicameral Mind*, that full self-referential consciousness is a cultural acquisition, and a relatively recent one at that, having appeared approximately 3000 years ago. Prior to that, Jaynes theorizes, people had auditory hallucinations which gave them the appropriate commands in stressful or novel situations. These were interpreted as the voices of gods, dead ancestors, or the local tribal ruler. Thus Jaynes accounts for the beginnings of religion. The commands actually originated in the right hemisphere of the brain, according to Jaynes, and were communicated to the language centers of the left hemisphere. Schizophrenia is a modern vestige of this once-common mode of "bicameral" thought.

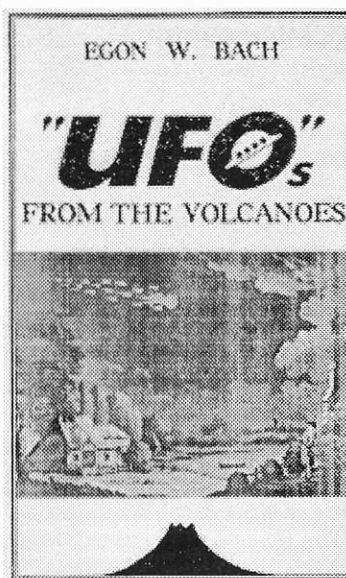
Though his ideas are controversial, Jaynes touches on some points that may have relevance to the encounter phenomenon.

Jaynes points to the large eyes on ancient statuary as supportive of his ideas. Jaynes looked at photographs and illustrations of Sumerian, Egyptian, and Olmec idols and measured the eye index: the proportion of the eye to the head, using the diameter of the eye as a measure. In ancient idols he found large eyes to be a consistent pattern, with a 17- to 20-percent eye index, while the eye index of a normal human face is 11 percent. The eye-to-eye experience, with its "unresolvedness" and "diminution of consciousness," was stylized through such art, allowing more fluid access to the right hemisphere and its voices of the gods. Jaynes believes such idols were built on the cusp of emerging human consciousness and had a primary function of accessing the voices, which were fading into silence as people moved toward higher civilization.

Whatever the merits of Jaynes's theories, it is interesting that ancient peoples were fashioning idols with huge eyes. In Jim Schnabel's *Dark White* (1994) the author is reminded of Jaynes's ideas when he learns that one abductee obsessively fashioned huge eyes on sculptures when she was a child.

Jaynes's ideas, strangely enough, also tie in with the ideas of neuroscientist Michael Persinger, who asserts that the visitor experience is the result of right-hemisphere activ-

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they are cold (as they reverse colors and turn black). Also they shrink and swell as they float and wiggle—change shape from balls into cones, then snaking shapes of electrical lustre—scaring us with the illusion of *live spirits*. I like to prospect with enthusiastic friends for this matter and map geothermal sites. Order *UFOs from the Volcanoes*, \$22 plus \$3 postage (400 pages, pictures, video review, methods) from Egon Bach, 4712 Oakdale Road, Modesto, CA 95357.

"UFO" matter is an odd mineral that calmly oozes from the volcanoes or is erupted violently. By drilling into the volcanoes we can extract it, but first we must sample it efficiently with airships above the oozing sites of the cool and harmless *Saint Elmo's Fires*, as known for centuries. They are nearly as warm or cool as our air but make us believe they are *hot* (as they turn red, gold, green, and blue) or

ity spilling over to the left hemisphere when ego boundaries are weakened. The left hemisphere perceives the right as entirely "other," and Persinger holds that this explains the sensation of a presence at night in the abduction experience. (It seems entirely plausible to me that this is true as far as it goes—but it may not go far enough. Perhaps a nonhuman intelligence is gaining access to consciousness through the right hemisphere.)

So where does all this oddly correlated material leave us? Is there some archetype of eye-to-eye contact creating some weird feedback loop in contemporary post-bicameral consciousness? Or is it something more, some nonhuman intelligence contacting us the only way it knows how, through evolutionary pathways already present in the human brain?

As usual we end with more questions than answers. UFO investigators would do well to consider the work of Persinger, even if it might complicate their world view. Skeptics would also do well to consider data that may force them to think a bit harder or even rethink things completely—particularly the evidence found in multiple-witness reports. ♦

CIRCLES

BY JEROME CLARK

Jim Schnabel, *Dark White: Aliens, Abductions, and the UFO Obsession*. London: Hamish Hamilton, 1994. 304p.

Jim Schnabel, *Round in Circles: Poltergeists, Pranksters, and the Secret History of Cropwatchers*. Amherst, N.Y.: Prometheus Books, 1994. 294p.

Attempts by outsiders to depict ufology's inner workings more often than not fall wide of the mark, and all too commonly the author cannot even be accused of harboring good intentions. The most recent example that comes to mind is Curtis Peebles's shoddy and dishonest *Watch the Skies!*—scathingly scrutinized in these pages by David M. Jacobs and Michael D. Swords (July/August *IUR*) and predictably puffed in *Skeptical Inquirer*, where debunking correctness has always counted for a whole lot more than adherence to scholarly or journalistic standards. (And if you don't believe me, ask yourself when was the last time you saw a debunking book panned there.)

Jim Schnabel's *Dark White* is more journalism than scholarship, but its intentions are good, and its intelligence is high. It will stand as a generally accurate picture of a portion of the early-1990s American UFO scene, principally Budd Hopkins's abduction circle. The rest of ufology is painted in the broadest of strokes, and here the book's limitations become apparent. On the other hand, it may not be fair to criticize Schnabel for not writing the book he did not intend to write.

More fairly criticized are some errors of varying degrees of seriousness. Schnabel contends (p. 61) that it was Hopkins who discovered phantom pregnancies among abductees, and then such things "began to show up prominently in other abduction accounts." The implication is clear, but Schnabel simply has his facts wrong. The first investigator to note such pregnancies, which he characterized as "hysterical," was John A. Keel. He refers to them several times, albeit without making a great deal of them, in *The Mothman Prophecies* (1975). Elsewhere, by the way, Schnabel oddly calls Keel a "scholar" (p. 245). Other characterizations come more readily to mind.

Jerome Clark, editor of IUR and vice president of CUFOS, is writing High Strangeness: UFOs from 1960 Through 1979, the third volume of The UFO Encyclopedia.

It is not true (p. 12n) that the "airship mystery was only rediscovered by ufologists in the mid 1960s." Airship sightings were reported in Charles Fort's *New Lands* (1923) and in one of the first books of the UFO era, Donald E. Keyhoe's *The Flying Saucers Are Real* (1950). Donald H. Menzel's *Flying Saucers* (1953) devoted a chapter to them, Edward J. Ruppelt's *The Report on Unidentified Flying Objects* (1956) mentioned them, and a number of 1950s UFO periodicals featured them. It is true, however, that sustained and systematic research on the question did not begin until the 1960s.

Alvin H. Lawson's amateurishly conceived and executed "imaginary abductions" experiment has been so thoroughly discredited that one is surprised to encounter it here (pp. 105–106) and to see it treated so uncritically. (Schnabel also neglects to mention Lawson's subsequent crankish ruminations about the relationship of "birth traumas" to abductions.) Psychosocial ufology gets similarly soft treatment, as do Michael Persinger's geophysical/neurological theories. Though Schnabel is certainly better informed than most journalistic chroniclers of ufology, he stumbles over occasional gaping, crippling holes in his knowledge.

CUFOS, which has contributed markedly to ufology's intellectually serious literature, is mentioned only in passing, usually with my name attached (a point to which I shall return momentarily). There is no indication that Schnabel has heard of the *Journal of UFO Studies*, much less read it. He has heard of *IUR* but apparently has not read it. I presume that is why he does not seem aware of the hard-hitting—and unanswered—critiques of Persinger's theory (by Chris Rutkowski) and of psychosocial and paranormal theories (separately by Thomas E. Bullard and me). No analysis of the abduction question can possibly ignore Rodeghier/Goodpaster/Blatterbauer's crucially important "Psychosocial Characteristics of Abductees" in *JUFOS* 3 (1991). Schnabel's grasp of issues related to the extraterrestrial hypothesis is to all intents and purposes nonexistent. Too bad he did not read Michael D. Swords on the subject, starting with "Science and the Extraterrestrial Hypothesis in Ufology" (*JUFOS* 1 [1989]) and "Does the ETH Make Sense?" (*IUR*, September/October 1992).

The only CUFOS-associated ufologist Schnabel interviewed was Eddie Bullard. (Actually, to be strictly accurate here, Bullard was not then a CUFOS board member.) He did

not speak with Swords and Mark Rodeghier, who would have provided him with perspectives and information not represented in *Dark White*. Schnabel did speak with me once, for the duration of a 60-second phone conversation, and asked for an article or two of mine on UFO-debunking practices. Though he could easily have solicited my views on the Linda Cortile episode, nothing was said on the

“... comes across like a well-crafted comic novel with a marvelous cast of characters...”

subject; thus I was surprised to find myself identified as a proponent of the case, when I am and have been thoroughly agnostic. I attended the October 1992 conference in Hopkins's Manhattan apartment not as a member of the “defense,” as Schnabel has it (p. 219), but as one who hoped (naively, I was soon to learn) to adjudicate what I feared (correctly, I am sorry to say) was devolving rapidly into a destructive and polarizing conflict.

Outside CUFOS Schnabel would have done well to interview David Gotlib, the Toronto physician who edits the excellent *Bulletin of Anomalous Experience*, the only scholarly periodical devoted solely to the abduction phenomenon. Since neither Gotlib nor *BAE* is mentioned, we must assume Schnabel heard of neither.

Schnabel cites David J. Hufford's Old Hag sleep-paralysis work which he argues, reasonably enough, is relevant to abduction research. Like other critics, however, Schnabel misses (or ignores) Hufford's larger argument—also relevant to abduction research—with its damning critique of “rationalist” preconceptions about anomalous events.

Even more unsatisfying is the coverage of Philip J. Klass. Schnabel is too smart to see Klass as anything other than yet another guy with a strongly held opinion, but the ufologically naive reader learns nothing from Schnabel about Klass's, mmm, shall we say obsessive style. That style, not Klass's disbelief in UFOs per se, is what has led most ufologists to hold him in disdain. Not a few skeptics harbor a comparable distaste for Klass's excesses; some have complained publicly about them. Strangely, Schnabel writes as if Klass's *UFOs—Identified* (1968) were something other than an exercise in pseudoscience—something like, say, a reasonable book. Klass himself, even more reluctant than most of us to admit error, has long maintained a telling silence on the plasma “theory” espoused therein. No wonder. One famous debunker has referred privately to *UFOs—Identified* as close to a crackpot book. Its thesis was debunked by scientifically sophisticated readers of every ufological persuasion, from atmospheric physicist James E. McDonald to plasma specialists consulted by the Condon Committee (see pages 748–50 of *Scientific Study of Unidentified Flying Objects*, Bantam edition).

It is easier, naturally, to harp on a book's flaws than to sing its virtues. *Dark White* does not lack virtues. Schnabel is conscientious and fair-minded, and he writes well. His failings owe to ignorance, not to malice, and his approach is never derisive. Schnabel does not dispute the phenomenon's puzzling and anomalous character. Though he is not prepared to embrace the literalist view, that aliens are kidnapping people, neither does he reject it as an absurd impossibility. His treatment of the two leading literalists, Hopkins and Jacobs, is respectful and affectionate.

In an epilogue he cobbles together his own extraordinary abduction hypothesis: an eclectic mix of dissociation, archetypes of the collective unconscious, multiple-personality disorder, abnormal neurological states, sexual hysteria, repression, parapsychological effects, and more. Since most of these phenomena are controversial in themselves, what Schnabel proposes is only marginally less paradigm-shaking than the alien-kidnapping concept. Still, one must admire his boldness and appreciate the thoughtfulness and creativity he brings to the discussion.

So far *Dark White*—the title, by the way, comes from an abductee's attempt to describe an abductor's skin color—has no American publisher. Schnabel's earlier *Round in Circles*, which saw print in England in 1993, now is available to American readers, thanks to the good people at Prometheus Books. In style and content it is much like *Dark White*: in other words, a journalistic excursion into a small circle of researchers, enthusiasts, debunkers, and mystics organized (and disorganized) around a seemingly enigmatic phenomenon. This time the setting is England, and the phenomenon is crop circles.

I concede that I am no authority on the subject. I will further confess that crop circles bored me from the outset and that I greeted their ignominious demise with selfish relief; now I wouldn't have to force myself to read anything more about them, even the sensible stuff (and there was some). I changed my mind long enough, however, to devour Schnabel's entertaining book in two or three sittings. *Round in Circles* comes across like a well-crafted comic novel with a marvelous cast of characters, ranging from sober (if ultimately misguided) researchers to shameless hucksters to certifiable fruitcakes.

Unlike the UFO/abduction saga, the crop-circle story has a beginning, an end, and a manageable number of players. While ufology is poised for the long haul (barring, of course, a White House landing or an official fessing-up about Roswell and the sudden obsolescence of the U in UFO), cereology is fast disappearing into a Bermuda triangle of sunken beliefs. It had nowhere else to go, once it was determined that the interesting “circles”—the pictograms—were hoaxed; the simpler ones evidently are natural anomalies which should interest meteorologists and just about nobody else.

In the decade-or-so reign of “mystery circles,” as we all know, many proclaimed that UFOs caused the circles. The

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IN SEARCH OF GIZMOS: A 1947 RADAR CASE

BY GREG LONG

S ometime in the spring of 1948, Kenneth Arnold landed his private plane at Eureka, California, and drove north on Highway 101 to an installation five miles northwest of Arcata. The installation was the Landing Aids Experiment Station located at the Eureka-Arcata Airport.

The station was a research project sponsored by the U.S. Navy, U.S. Army, and the Civil Aviation Administration. Its mission, in part, was to advance the development of radar technology gained during World War II so that radar could be successfully applied to the commercial aircraft industry. Using improved radar systems, operators in control towers would talk pilots down—help them execute blind landings in conditions of minimal visibility. Arcata was the foggiest place in the nation, the perfect place to test new radar systems and landing methods.

Aircraft from the Navy, Army, and (later) commercial airlines, such as United and Southwest, took part in the radar-landing experiments from 1946 until 1950 when bureaucratic wrangling closed the project. Experiments were conducted during the day and night, usually a maximum of two a day. The pilots flew in from various California bases and even from as far away as Wright-Patterson AFB, Dayton, Ohio. Aircraft such as B-29s, C-47s, even early jets such as the F9F, took part in the experiments, and only if there was zero-zero weather: no ceiling and no visibility.

Less than a year had gone by since Kenneth Arnold's sensational June 24, 1947, sighting of nine unidentified metallic-looking objects flying at phenomenal speed down the backbone of the Cascade Mountains in Washington state. Arnold had come to the experiment station to find Kenneth Ehlers. The *Saturday Evening Post* had published Wesley Price's article "The Sky Is Haunted" in its March 6, 1948, issue, and after reading it, Arnold set out to look up a man mentioned there.

The lead-in had read, "I keep telling myself that I don't believe in ghost airplanes." Price proceeded to recount how Ehlers, "a blond giant" at the Landing Aids Experiment

Station, had been detecting "gizmos" on his radarscope for a year. The gizmos were radar targets, or "pips," which could never be seen with the naked eye. Ehlers was logging the flight patterns of the gizmos to Dr. Florence W. Van Straten, a Navy meteorologist, and Dr. Luis W. Alvarez, the inventor of Ground Control Approach System (GCA) radar.

Arnold had one question on his mind: Were the gizmos flying saucers?

LOOKING FOR MR. EHLERS

Many years later, in 1980, I would interview Arnold in his Boise, Idaho, home. (That visit was the subject of an article I published in *MUFON UFO Journal*, November 1981.) I would learn during that interview that Arnold was quite a UFO investigator. His private plane and his business (selling fire-fighting equipment throughout the Pacific Northwest) afforded him convenient access to witnesses. In fact, he said that his basement was full of case material he had collected. Arnold refused to let me tape-record him; but in the afternoon he let me record some of his own tapes. One of these was his interview with Ehlers.

I let the tape sit for several years. Then in the mid-1980s I began a search for Ehlers. All I knew about him was that he had worked at an experimental radar station in northern California. While at the radar station, he was in his mid-20s. Would he have settled down in California? On a hunch I checked *Who's Who in the West*. There he was, at the University of California at Berkeley. But other work interrupted my pursuit of him. In 1985 Arnold died in Seattle while visiting family. Time passed. Then, in August of this year, I dug out Arnold's tape and checked *Who's Who* again.

Kenneth Ehlers had impressive credentials: post-graduate work at MIT; 35 years (beginning in 1950) at the Lawrence Berkeley Labs; a consultant to nuclear-related corporations, including the Cyclotron Corporation in Berkeley; on the editorial board of the *Review of Scientific Instruments*. I consulted directory assistance and called him.

Yes, he remembered "Kenny Arnold." Ehlers laughed. "Ken told me a few wild things, such as an aunt who saw things," he said. "But I was very interested in what Ken ran into."

Greg Long, author of Examining the Earthlight Theory, published by CUFOS in 1990, contributes frequently to IUR.

And these gizmos? What did he think they were after all these years?

THE ORIGINAL INTERVIEW

Before we hear from Ehlers, let's turn first to Arnold's interview with the radar experimenter. Ehlers's statements that follow are measured and matter of fact; they even seem prepared, as if Ehlers had gone through the problem many times before. Arnold's questions are in italics.

My name is Kenneth Ehlers. I'm head of the Electronic Aids Department, Landing Aids Experiment Station, which is located on the coastline near Arcata, California. At Mr. Arnold's request I'm going to give a brief summary of some work that I have done relative to radar returns from the lower atmosphere as viewed by radar.

I went to school at the University of Colorado, joined the Navy, was made a radar technician, went to Oklahoma A&M, and through approximately nine Navy electronic schools including some time at MIT. During that time I became very well-acquainted with radar, aided in building the initial GCA unit during the war, was an instructor in that equipment. After the war I came to work at this activity where we are using a very wide variety of electronic aids including various components of radar equipment.

During the past three years and a lot of work at this activity, we who have operated the radar have noticed that there are targets which we call "radar returns" in the atmosphere, the occurrence of which, though obvious, we cannot see with the naked eye. Moving from the interior of the radar trailer to the outside to scan the atmosphere, we are unable to discern any signal, or any target or any object whatsoever. This naturally has created some interest among our group . . . and for that reason we have done a slight amount of extra work during our spare time in an attempt to determine just what this echo is.

Returning to the type of returns I have viewed, I made a log using the radar indications relative to time, date, the type of weather in which I was observing the return, and attempted to do this work on somewhat of a scientific basis. I noticed the targets would appear more often perhaps in the summer than in the winter. They would appear out over the ocean area which we scan, which is completely free of all radar type of returns, the antenna which scans above sea level, thereby eliminating everything as far as boats, ocean return, and the like [are concerned], and leaves only the returns from the atmosphere to be viewed. The antenna of the machine . . . I use can be tilted, and as the beam is quite narrow, I can scan the upper atmosphere as well as the lower atmosphere. The speed of the type of target which I have been following is approximately 30 miles an hour; its direction is perhaps very constant, with a perhaps 15-degree

change right or left to this particular heading, which is approximately one-eight-zero degrees. The speed, 30 miles an hour, is constant or very constant, despite any wind direction or velocity as recorded on the surface. The altitude of the indications ranges in the vicinity of 3000 feet. This level holds quite constant.

After observing these targets, I was very much interested in what other radar equipment had observed, whether it was a common thing of which I had not heard, or whether it was actually something new, or something that was just being observed. I contacted Dr. Alvarez, who was a noted electronic authority, including radar, one of the original designers of the GCA equipment. He was very interested, and by speaking to numerous authorities . . . with whom he was acquainted, he was able to determine that it had never been reported.

Other authorities [with whom] I conversed were Dr. Florence Van Straten, U.S. Navy aerologist, who was very interested in the returns . . . insofar as they may have a relative bearing to meteorological happenings. The return has been viewed by other authorities I have found, but the type of return they have been viewing and the method of viewing the return is quite different from mine. On the returns which have been viewed elsewhere, which have since been dubbed "angels," several theories of their presence have been offered.

Dr. Gordon, Director of Microwave Astronomy at Cornell University, has presented a theory as to the cause of these unidentified radar returns from the lower atmosphere. This theory would state that the return is due to a turbulence of the atmosphere, which in turn could cause a dielectric shift or change which, though difficult to explain in terms of the layman, would return for the radar set a signal which could be viewed. However, for the work here, it is definitely—we are definitely not able to substantiate this theory, though we are not completely able to disprove it. It would seem that if the theory is true, the signal could be generated or bred by the use of FIDO, which we have available, whereby intense heat is created to eliminate fog. This action in turn should create sufficient turbulence to be viewed by the radar screen. This has not happened, and perhaps the method of generating them is not sufficient or proper; however, if that has not happened thus far . . . we do not believe . . . at the moment . . . that the turbulence is the exact answer.

The return has since been viewed on several radar-type equipment. We have checked definitely to be very sure that the target return is not generated by the image of a bird, by malfunctioning of the equipment, or by the type of frequency used. Virtually every plausible explanation has been thoroughly investigated and has been discarded. In my mind I have not come to any conclusion as to what the radar return is, what is actually causing the return. . . . I am certain, I should say, that it is not caused by something that we can see . . . such as birds, insects, malfunctioning of the equipment, and the like. What

these echoes are actually due to, I cannot state. However, I do feel it is definitely time to figure out what causes them as they have caused us, in turn, considerable headache.

For example, in handling aircraft in this type of work, it is necessary to direct the aircraft into positions where there are no obstructions. If an echo of this type is in the area, we cannot use that area, as we cannot definitely establish from the ground that it is not another aircraft, a smaller type. For that reason we must . . . fly the aircraft completely free of any area in which these echoes are present. The use of new types of equipment such as at MTI, which will eliminate all targets from the scope, will not eliminate these targets . . . as they also move . . . and will be present despite any type of circuit. . . . So these little fellas do present a problem.

Well, Mr. Ehlers, would there be a difference, for instance, if we took a very giant airplane and it crossed the path of your scope, would it appear differently [from] a small airplane? Oh yes, definitely. In two respects. A small aircraft would not return the amount of signal that the large aircraft would, and in most cases a small aircraft, considering it is not a military fighter, would move much slower than the large aircraft, and the speed can be used then to determine the difference as well as the target return itself. The trained operator could tell the difference.

Well, now on these . . . mystery objects that you've been tracking, do they appear in comparison with the ordinary airplane that you do track here occasionally? Do they compare equal in power, or less power, or just what way would you be able to determine their size? No, I cannot state their size. The time of return in most cases . . . is less than that of the average aircraft. However, at close-in ranges when you have plenty of transmit power and receive signal, their target is very close in relative size to that of the average aircraft. At greater distances the aircraft will return a greater signal. This in turn can be credited to perhaps the difference in makeup of the target, its size, or perhaps the actual distance itself.

But they appear on the radar scope as something with density, I mean, metal density such as an aircraft. Now you've probably experimented here with DC-3s, DC-6s, and things of that type, and you are saying that when one of these things [is] very close to your radar scope, you would interpret it as a DC-3? Would you say it would give as large a signal as that, or as bright as one? I would rather say an aircraft slightly smaller, perhaps an SNB, or an aircraft similar to the type that you fly.

But it's a rather phenomenal thing that they only go up about 30 miles an hour. You'd think they couldn't stay up. If they go 30 miles an hour, they are quite a radical departure from our present aircraft design, if they are an aircraft.

Now, you have observed these in the daytime, when the sky was clear, and you have been able to observe

these objects on the scope and determine their position and direction of travel and gone out and looked up to where they should be and you cannot see them. That is right.

And yet you have been able to determine the same thing as aircraft, only you can look up and see the aircraft? That is true. When the target is seen, I have

“ . . . on numerous occasions I have seen them come to what one could assume to be a complete halt, and in some cases the target split and departed by a few degrees in opposite directions . . . ”

been able to go outside the trailer and by the use of glasses, both by myself and aides in doing some of this work, nothing has been spotted, and nothing has been spotted by aircraft [which] are directly in the vicinity of the target which we view on the radar screen.

Now, you mention that several times they would continue a course across this area and then stop before you lost them out of the screen and make a turn, or move away from their original course or pathway? That's right. Their heading is primarily constant, one-eight-zero as I've described before. However, on numerous occasions I have seen them come to what one could assume to be a complete halt, and in some cases the target split and departed by a few degrees in opposite directions, and the two targets in turn paralleled each other on the one-eight-zero heading. I have seen them turn slightly right or left, but in most cases they have continued their primary heading of approximately one-eight-zero.

You mean by the target splitting, in other words you have one target, and it continues into the field here, and then all of a sudden it divides itself? That's right. It divides itself right in the middle. Two targets of about half intensity of the primary target will go along side by side, and then some distance further, maybe two or three miles, they may merge together as one and be gone.

In the last year there has been the claim that the target return was generated by the presence of insects. Investigating this plausible or perhaps possible explanation, I have tracked aircraft into the vicinity of the echo, placed them on a direct collision course at as close an altitude I could possibly determine, and had the aircraft pilots observe everything ahead of them, any reactions to the aircraft, and any other thing that they could observe by any of their normal senses. No reports were forthcoming. Virtually every plausible explanation has been thoroughly investigated and has been discarded.

LOOKING BACK

So, 46 years later, what did Ehlers now think was the source of the invisible targets?

"I'd love to believe in flying saucers," Ehlers told me over the phone. "I believe in UFOs, but I don't believe in flying saucers. A flying saucer indicates there's somebody aboard with sense. UFOs are unidentified flying objects. An object can be Lord knows what. My objects [at Arcata] are a flying object. They aren't seen by the eye, but they're seen by radar. So they're a UFO. But they're not a flying saucer."

Here were objects that appeared materially real. They could be detected by electromagnetic waves. They were a repeating phenomenon. Their estimated size was that of a small aircraft. Their altitude could be estimated, their direction tracked, their duration (30 mph) measured. Time and again, Ehlers had viewed the objects on his scope and sought every possible explanation. Yes, the objects certainly seemed real and clearly unexplained.

Another intriguing feature of the Ehlers story was the presence of Luis Alvarez. After Ehlers's stay at Arcata, Alvarez got him a job at Berkeley, where both men remained throughout their careers as professionals and close friends. Alvarez died in 1988; Ehlers is a retired professor.

Alvarez's accomplishments are enormous, guaranteeing him a permanent place in the history of physics. He worked on microwave radar research at MIT (1940–1943); participated in the development of the atomic bomb at Los Alamos Scientific Lab, New Mexico (1944–1945); at Berkeley helped construct the first proton linear accelerator and developed the liquid hydrogen bubble chamber; promoted his son Walter's hypothesis of dinosaur extinction due to climatic changes caused by dust from an asteroid or comet impacting the earth. But most importantly, Alvarez won the Nobel Prize in 1968 for his work in physics, which included the discovery of resonance particles (short-lived particles occurring in high-energy nuclear collisions).

Alvarez was also a member of the infamous Robertson Panel made up of scientists and chaired by H. P. Robertson of the Department of Defense. The panel, convened by the CIA, met from January 14 to 17, 1953, to evaluate about 20 UFO reports and two UFO films. At the conclusion of the discussions, the CIA decided that the UFO subject should be debunked to discourage public interest and inquiry. Alvarez served on the panel as an expert in radar.

As a radar expert Alvarez participated in the development of microwave beacons, linear radar antennas, the ground-controlled landing approach system, and a method for aerial bombing using radar to locate targets. Alvarez was a top, if not the top, American radar authority in his time.

He was intrigued by the gizmos, Price reported. Alvarez apparently provided Price with an explanation for them: they were a "discontinuity in atmospheric conditions." Ionized air, for example, could fit the profile of such a "discontinuity." Radar could "see" ionization from a meteor's trail, though ordinary ionization usually appeared as "dim,

sprawling blotches." The problem was how to pack enough ions into a space small enough to imitate an aircraft on the radar screen.

Ehlers and Alvarez discussed this problem many times, Ehlers told me. And over the years Ehlers began to develop a theory to account for what he "saw": multiple variation excitation.

Ehlers's theory takes off from the discontinuity concept laid forth in 1948. "It's a little wild," he admits. "Underline it with big question marks and put quotes around it."

Controlled thermonuclear plasmas are normally made of positive ions and electrons. In the laboratory a filament is heated using hundreds of volts (perhaps a kilovolt); this emits electrons from the filament. Rushing through the medium in the laboratory vessel (hydrogen gas, for example), the electrons "knock" electrons off the neutral hydrogen atoms, generating positive ions and electrons (or positive charges and negative charges). This is plasma production using "hot electrons."

But is it possible to produce both positive ions and negative ions? In this case, electrons are knocked off the atoms and attach themselves to other atoms, giving them an extra electron. This process involves photons.

Photons of the right frequency and energy (measured in angstroms and electron volts) excite the molecules of hydrogen. With enough photons, a "gang effect" occurs, photons adding to each other, and the highly excited molecules break apart. Some electrons join other electrons on hydrogen atoms, making H⁻. Left behind are some atoms missing an electron, or H⁺. Now we have negative hydrogen ions and positive hydrogen ions. The plasma that results can exist for some time, depending upon how many ions are made and lost.

Conceivably, then, there could be a plasma generated at a low energy state with photons. "You couldn't do it with energetic electrons," Ehlers told me. "They'd tear the electrons off the H⁻."

At Arcata, Ehlers went on, there is plenty of seawater. The Landing Aids Experiment Station was located near the edge of a precipitous bluff 200 feet above crashing waves. And that means there's chlorine: chlorine is in salt water.

Electrons are bound loosely to the chlorine atoms, and it wouldn't take too many vibrations from photons for a molecule to come apart, leaving us with Cl⁺ and Cl⁻. Generating such a plasma using photons could be possible in the summer. There is plenty of sunlight over the ocean. "With photons you have numerous chances," he said. "With a million photons you get a million chances. What you can do with multiple impacts. . . . You could end up with a plasma big enough to divert a radar beam."

But how long would such a plasma last? Ions want to combine, Ehlers replied, to return to their normal neutral state. But under certain conditions they would have great difficulty combining; they would merely coalesce rather than blow apart.

"You can see the little things wiggling around trying to

find an opposite charge," he said. "But maybe the normal atmospheric pressure is high enough that molecules get in the way and they can't get to where they'd like to. They could conceivably exist for some time. There would be, conceivably, a decay mechanism and undoubtedly a production mechanism going on at the same time, or they would go out."

Based on his observations and conversations with the control tower at the station, Ehlers began to wonder if the targets were occurring at the inversion layer where areas of warm air meet areas of cooler air. Was chlorine somehow being held in the inversion layer out over the ocean? Salt from the ocean would rise up (in some form) from the ocean and run into a ceiling of cold air, which would prevent the salt from rising. Numbers of photons would increase to the point at which sunlight would make a plasma of sufficient intensity to be seen on radar.

Of course I had all kinds of questions. The targets moved from northwest to southeast at a near-constant 30-mph speed, "despite any wind direction or velocity as recorded on the surface" (Arnold interview). "They fly upward, downwind, or crosswind" (Price's story). "Well," Ehlers remarked, "I don't know what's going on at the inversion layer."

The targets were always traveling in the same path—coming from Trinidad Head and heading over the coast. Could wind currents at the inversion level account for the path? Are wind currents at the inversion level different from wind currents above and below? "I just don't know," Ehlers said.

Why wouldn't the positive and negative charges recombine, collapsing the plasma? The charges want to get together, Ehlers said, like a rubber band pulling them together, an attraction. If there was nothing in between (as in a vacuum), they would be pulled together and become neutral, and "that would be the end of it." But with atmospheric pressure, the positive and negative charges "bounce" from molecule to molecule and can't get together. The charges would exist in a compact space because of their attraction.

How could a plasma halt in its path or split into two and miles later merge? Ehlers had no answer.

PUTTING THE PIECES TOGETHER

The Arcata observations puzzled Luis Alvarez. He visited the station and, like Ehlers, looked for insects, birds, and other objects to account for the targets. Seeing nothing, he offered a number of technical suggestions. None explained the phenomenon. While at the experiment station, Ehlers kept Alvarez informed, sending photographs of the pips on the radar scope and relevant data. "For 30 years," Ehlers recalled, "we spent time arguing about [the targets]."

Ehlers's theory is intriguing. It combines a number of known components and conditions to arrive at an interesting proposition. But is the theory more complex than it needs to

be? The observations occurred during the juvenile period of radar development, a technology of war requiring further testing, improvements, and refinements as it found new applications after the war. Were Ehlers and Alvarez simply ignorant of what radar could detect given unusual conditions? Though aware of "angels" (false returns), was either man, given the state of the art and the knowledge that existed at the time, fully aware of the extent of anomalous radar propagation?

Normally radar transmits a beam of electromagnetic radiation at a target. The beam is reflected off the target and received by the radar system, where the target is amplified and displayed. Yet anomalous propagation of radar targets can occur under certain atmospheric conditions. Superrefraction occurs when radar beams are bent when atmospheric conditions are just right, typically on clear, calm summer nights when a temperature inversion is prevalent. During superrefraction, the radar beams are trapped between the superrefractive layer and the ground and can propagate at great distances beyond the normal horizon, in fact bending in an arc having the same or greater curvature of the earth's surface and traveling great distances.

In this scenario the radar sees targets below the normal horizon. Normally radar operators are alerted to superrefracted targets due to the excessive ground clutter that the extended beam picks up. But in Ehlers's case he was looking toward the Pacific Ocean where there was no ground clutter. Ehlers does theorize that the anomalous targets he detected were somehow connected to inversion layers, and most of his targets were observed during summer. Could he have been "seeing" regular flights of aircraft, such as military operations, many hundreds of miles away?

The opposite of superrefraction is subrefraction. Subrefraction offers the more obvious solution. In this case radio waves are refracted (bent) upward by excessive turbulence (caused by hot air) in the layers of the atmosphere. The radar beams are reflected off mirrorlike patches of the atmospheric layer. The result is telling and matches Ehlers's observations almost point by point. Ronald D. Story's *Encyclopedia of UFOs* (1980) has this to say on pages 294–95:

[T]he reflecting patches normally drift with the prevailing winds at the level of the layer. . . . [T]he false targets will move in the same direction as the winds at the layer level and—because of the geometry—at twice the speed of those winds. Second, because of the reduction in the strength of the reflected signal from the layer with increasing elevation angle, returns of this type will be seen to fade out if they "approach" the radar site more closely than ten or twenty miles. . . . [There is also] the tendency for a large return to break up into a number of smaller returns as it approaches the radar or, conversely, for a number of small returns to merge into a large return as they retreat from the radar site.

Ehlers postulates that his targets are associated with inversion layers and the moving air at the inversion layer. His observations of splitting and merging blips are strikingly similar to targets generated by subrefracted and reflected beams. Do we have an answer? Ehlers did tell me that Alvarez, when he visited the station, looked for superrefraction as a solution, using the pulse frequency recurrence control to detect any shifts of the targets over distance. Their distance did not change.

Unfortunately, time has taken its toll, and Ehlers's logs of his observations and recorded weather conditions have

vanished. We are left with memory and a few photographs of the radar scopes. The regularity and consistent direction of travel of Ehlers's targets certainly suggest a natural explanation. We have no sudden angular turns or high speeds, no sudden changes in altitude, no confirming visual observations of an airborne target.

Was Arnold right to equate the gizmos with flying saucers? Or were they all anomalous propagation? Or could they have been something more exotic, from a still-to-be-explored area of ionization? We may never know. ♦

CASE MISSING

BY MICHAEL D. SWORDS

In late August of this year, I was indulging in a great privilege and luxury: the pawing-through of an unsorted box from the back room at the CUFOS office. In it was the normal array of almost unmanageable news clippings and correspondence which are a filer's nightmare. Turning over an old leaf revealed a duplicate original of an Air Technical Intelligence Center (ATIC) document, circa June 1952. Interested, I read on and learned the following:

Kirksville, Missouri, June 23, 1952. Airman 1st Class Ray H. Foote, a radar man with 12 months' experience at the equipment, was on duty at the Radar PPI scope. It was 7:30 p.m. A hard blip reminiscent of a B-29 aircraft manifested itself 90 miles to the north-northwest (almost dead north). It began painting a straight regular track at 357 degrees for 120 miles over a two-minute period. Then it vanished.

Lt. A. N. Robinson, Jr., sat down at the console. It was 7:35 p.m. A hard blip reminiscent of a B-29 aircraft manifested itself 85 miles to the north-northwest. It followed a straight regular track on the exact heading of its previous twin. One hundred twenty-five miles later, at the spot of the previous bogey's vanishing, it, too, left the scope. Its travel time was approximately 1 3/4 minutes.

Recorded speed: 3600+ miles. Said Ray Foote, "It was moving very fast."

The vanishing may or may not have been simply because the blips "passed the limit of the equipment" (but the grids they used had more space to play with). The ATIC

investigation forms do not say, though an accompanying teletype makes this mention. So let's keep the mystery to a minimum and say that they just passed out of range.

What else do the forms say? Was the equipment operating properly? Yes. Were these operators familiar with the effects of anomalous propagation? Yes. Do such conditions exist? No. What effect do rainstorms and clouds have on this radar? (There was a storm in the northeast.) Additional clutter. Was this relevant to the report? No. Were any checks made to determine if the target could have been one of our aircraft? No. No means available. How did the targets appear? Sharp, bright blip comparable with the return from a B-50 or B-36 type of aircraft. Was the target of consistent size? Yes. Was the speed of the target constant? Yes. Did the target appear fuzzy? No. Clear and sharp and comparable to the normal return from an aircraft.

Who saw the targets? Three controllers, two radar officers, and two maintenance and operations crewmen.

Seven persons. 3600+ mph. Two minutes in the sky. "Could it have been one of our own?" I doubt it, Colonel.

Col. Donald L. Bower, Edward J. Ruppelt's boss, was naturally a wee bit interested in the report and asked for all the available information to be sent to AFOIN-AT1AA-5 (translation, Capt. Ruppelt, Project Blue Book). Showing that all wasn't wired tight in the intelligence network, he asked for the data on the sighting of six unidentified objects. Maybe he was just making sure that he got all the scoop. This request also wasn't even sent to Kirksville until July 18. Admittedly, they were busy in the summer of 1952.

Well, what a wonderful case. I wondered if Richard Hall lists it in *The UFO Evidence*. Hall was, and is, our number-one smart man on these sorts of things. Still, it wasn't there. That was odd, I thought. Well, let's see what the Blue Book microfilms say. Here is what they say:

"Case missing . . . conclusion: Unidentified." ♦

Michael D. Swords, Ph.D., a CUFOS board member and former editor of the Journal of UFO Studies, is at work on a history of the UFO phenomenon.

CRAFT VS. LIGHTS

BY WILLY SMITH

In his article "Scientific Studies of Unidentified Flying Objects" (*IUR*, January/February) Chris Rutkowski proposes, among other potential research projects, statistical studies. He suggested, as one testable hypothesis, this assertion: "Nocturnal lights comprise 60% of all UFO reports."

In the popular mind UFOs are things that move fleetingly in the sky, in the majority of cases luminous phenomena without much substance. Even some ufologists, who should know better, waste their time elaborating lists of cases that are nothing but lights. For example, about 70% of the cases Allan Hendry considers in his *UFO Handbook* (1979) are nocturnal lights.

A legitimate question, then, is to use a sophisticated database like UNICAT to decide if the predominance of lights is real, and what percentage of the entries refer to structured objects. A simple solution is to look up the percentage of nocturnal lights (NL) in the distribution by UFO types, where we find the value of 18.5% (when the database had $n = 800$ entries) and 17.4% (for $n = 700$ entries) and assume that the remaining incidents refer to solid objects.

For a variety of reasons, however, this is not quite correct. For instance, nocturnal lights by definition correspond to distant incidents (more than 500 feet) and thus lack detail. But it might happen that their true nature is evidenced by their passage in front of other objects, such as the moon or distant lights, and such a possibility is taken into account by the parameter MO (material object evidence) which appears in 8.25% of UNICAT's entries, certainly not a negligible contribution.

The two parameters in UNICAT applicable to the situation are (1) CR (craft), which refers to the cases where the presence of a structured, solid, material object is listed in the report, and (2) NO (no object), which applies to those events when only lights have been observed. We also have the cases detected only by radar (RO), with no visual confirmation, about which doubt always remains whether they were caused by operational malfunctioning. Each case will exhibit one or the other of those parameters CR and NO, or none, or both. The last instance is rare, and we find only six cases in the database, corresponding to different stages of the same sighting or to diverging testimony of the observers. The table below shows the results for $n = 800$ entries.

Thus, according to UNICAT, structured objects pre-

Willy Smith, Ph.D., is head of the UNICAT Project, a database for high-quality UFO events.

Craft vs. Lights ($n = 800$)

CR	NO	<i>n</i>	%	UFO
xx	—	565	70.6	
—	xx	210	26.3	
—	—	19	2.4	RO
xx	xx	6	0.7	C1, C2

dominate, even without considering the marginal radar cases. 70.6% of the entries correspond to the material object category. This is an enormous difference from results reported by other investigators in the literature—probably because these writers are using unscreened catalogues. ♦

Roswell videos

Paul Davids, executive producer of the Showtime movie *Roswell*, has assembled TV coverage, interviews, lectures, and other Roswelliana in two new videos: *Down in Roswell* (58 minutes) and *Reply to the Air Force Report on the Roswell Incident* (59 minutes). Outtakes and promos from the *Roswell* movie are featured, as well as a new song, "Down in Roswell." The videotapes cost \$33.95 each (including postage and handling), or \$58.95 for both. Make checks payable to Paul Davids and send to Coverup Video, 1107 Fair Oaks Ave., #261, South Pasadena, CA 91030. For PAL format, add \$30.00 per tape, plus \$15.00 overseas postage each.

George Eberhart's Top 10 List of UFO-related music

10. Brownsville Station, *Martian Boogie* (1977)
9. Holy Modal Rounders, *Mr. Spaceman* (1964)
8. Weird Al Yankovic, *Attack of the Radioactive Hamsters from a Planet near Mars* (1989)
7. Creedence Clearwater Revival, *It Came Out of the Sky* (1969)
6. Peter Wolf, *Mars Needs Women* (1984)
5. Jimmy Durante, *We're Goin' UFOin'* (1966)
4. The Buchanan Brothers, *When You See Those Flying Saucers* (1949?)
3. Billy Lee Riley, *Flying Saucer Rock'n'Roll* (1957)
2. The Ran-Dells, *The Martian Hop* (1963)
1. Julie Brown, *Earth Girls Are Easy* (1986)

Honorable Mention: Buddy and Claude, *Flying Saucers* (July 1947)—haven't heard this one, but it may be the first saucer song. *Flying Disc*, by Todd Rhodes and His Toddlers (July 1947), is probably the first UFO-named jazz instrumental.

LETTERS

POSTSCRIPT ON THE HILL CASE

To the editor:

Regarding Robert Coddington's letter (May/June *IUR*) about my role in the Betty and Barney Hill case, I must say I would have handled many aspects of the investigation into this experience quite differently today. Little did I or anyone else at the time realize the truly historic import of this encounter. As it was, the Hill case was my very first exposure to a CE3 episode, not to mention a virtually unprecedented abduction claim. I know that my skeptical mind tended to be somewhat selective during the investigation, and not everything was explored that should have been.

Enter those shiny round spots on the Hills' car. The only further clarification I can produce besides what is already in Fuller's book comes in my letter to Richard Hall, then NICAP assistant director. Dated September 17, 1965, the letter included the following:

Concerning the circular spots on the car, I unfortunately failed to attach much importance to the "beeps" in '61 and it seems to me that I casually looked at the car [as I left the witness interview] but recall seeing nothing out of the ordinary. I believe there were spots on the trunk, but they didn't impress me at the time as being of suspicious origin.

As a matter of fact, much later I recall viewing similar spots on my own vehicle and realized that they had a natural cause due to some sort of weather-related or road precipitate. Those spots, too, gradually faded away. I believe Betty's description of the spots was somewhat exaggerated, and in her postencounter excitement she quite naturally was *looking* for something on the car that might explain the "beeps." And, of course, passing a compass over a large metallic object such as an automobile will cause the needle to spin.

Philip Klass, responding on the same page, is up to his old tricks of distorting or leaving out basic facts in order to make his point. He attributes the Hills' missing time to their slowdowns to watch the UFO and especially to Barney's "decision" to turn off Route 3 to escape the UFO. In listing the page references in Fuller's book which point to evidence of Barney's "decision," Klass fails to cite for the reader the witness's quotes on those pages. If he had, they would have plainly shown Barney's *puzzlement* and apparent *involuntary* action in turning onto an isolated back road—rather than making a conscious decision to do so as implied by Klass.

In any case, the Hills' slowdowns, several brief stops, and a 35-mile side trip down a back road still don't add up to between two and three hours of missing time.

Walter N. Webb
Westwood, Massachusetts

UNKNOWN MISSILES

To the editor:

Your recent article by Clas Svahn and Anders Liljegren on close encounters with unknown missiles (July/August *IUR*) reminds me of an incident that happened nearly four decades ago.

On the night of December 1, 1957, at 1:30 a.m. Central European Time, Swissair pilot Walter Borner, flying a DC-6B at 5,500 meters from Athens to Cairo, observed over Cape Al Kanais, west of Alexandria, "a giant, red, burning cylinder falling down vertically, leaving a yellowish trail" (*Tiroler Tageszeitung*, December 11, 1957, crediting the *Tribune de Geneve*).

The newspaper report states that Borner was certain the object was not a meteor, and that he had observed the reentry of the booster rocket of Sputnik I, launched on October 4 the same year. In fact, Borner might have seen that rocket's final stage (1957 Alpha 1), which reentered the same day. But if I remember correctly, there was never a confirmation by Soviet authorities or by American space surveillance that Borner's sighting was the Sputnik rocket.

Luis Schoenherr
Innsbruck, Austria

Alien Discussions

Alien Discussions, the proceedings of the Abduction Study Conference held at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology, June 13–17, 1992, has just been published. The Conference, chaired by David E. Pritchard and John E. Mack, was organized to produce an overview of the abduction phenomenon from the vantage points of investigator, therapist, abductee, scientist, medical doctor, psychologist, theologian, folklorist, and skeptic. More than 100 papers and presentations are followed by questions from the well-informed audience.

Alien Discussions contains a glossary and a 50-page index that enhance access for in-depth researchers. Also included are John Mack's paper on "Why the Abduction Phenomenon Cannot Be Explained Psychiatrically," reports on the Richard Price implant and the MRI images of alleged implants, and a 50-page survey of abduction investigators recently completed by Eddie Bullard.

The members of the Abduction Study Conference were Eddie Bullard, John S. Carpenter, David A. Gotlib, Richard Hall, Budd Hopkins, David M. Jacobs, Pam Kasey, Joe Nyman, Mark Rodeghier, Michael Swords, and Walter Webb.

A copy may be ordered for \$55.00 (U.S. postage and handling included) from Proceedings, P.O. Box 241, North Cambridge Post Office, Cambridge, MA 02140. For mailings outside the United States, please send \$60.00 in U.S. currency per copy.

PROJECT MOGUL—continued from page 7

Using the available Project Mogul documentation we learn that Flight 8 was launched at 0303 MST on July 3. The flight lasted 195 minutes (3 hours, 15 minutes) before it landed. The general track was to the northwest (see map), and it maintained a roughly constant altitude of 18,000 feet for just about an hour. Just over forty-eight hours later, Flight 10 was launched at 0501 MST. The flight lasted over 512 minutes, when it was over Albuquerque, and it was eventually lost over Colorado. Its general track was to the north, and it maintained a constant altitude of about 9,000 feet for several hours.

Between these two was Flight 9, launched about 1930 MST (7:30 p.m.) from Alamogordo. No data about the direction of this flight or the location of its wreckage has been found to date. However, we know the direction taken by the balloon launched before it and the direction of the balloon launched after it. Both flew in a generally northerly direction. However, the Brazel ranch site is to the northeast of Alamogordo.

Given that both Flight 8 and 10 were found down or tracked to the north, not northeast, of Alamogordo, it seems reasonable to assume that Flight 9 followed a similar path since it was launched between the two. Without precise winds aloft data, this is, of course, speculation, but it is reasonable speculation. From the characteristics of those two flights, there is no reason to assume that Flight 9 would have taken a different track.

What this means, simply put, is that the tracks of the balloons launched little more than twelve hours before Flight 9 and less than thirty-six hours after it, give us a best estimate for the ground track of that flight. And it suggests that Flight 9 would not have come within sixty miles of the Brazel ranch.

The bottom line here is that there is no hard evidence for Pflock's Mogul theory that Flight 9 was the source of the debris. The documentation presented to date does not confirm it, and the testimony suggesting it is weak.

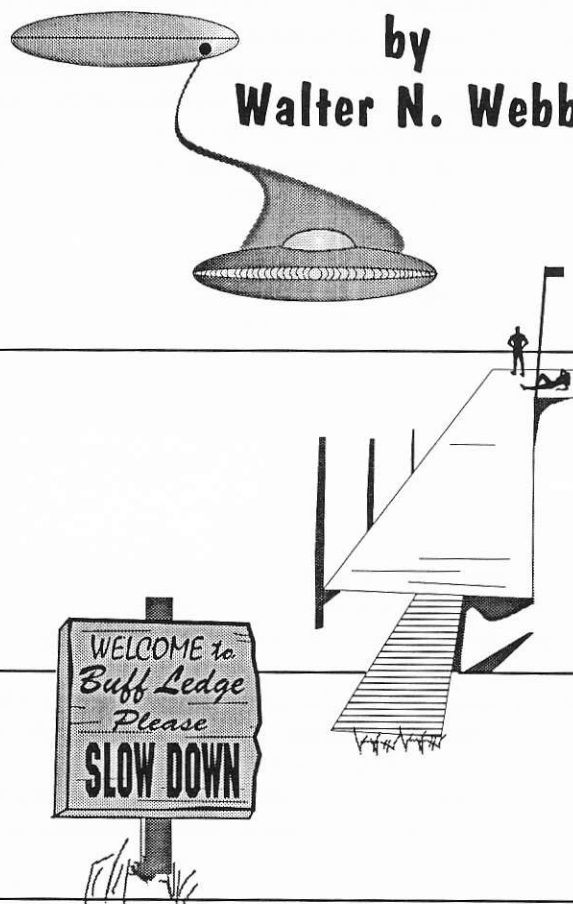
Rather than continue to debate about witness testimony, I have taken steps to move the investigation forward. I have ordered the winds aloft charts for June and July 1947 for New Mexico from the National Climatic Data Center in Asheville, N.C. Although that data cannot prove that what fell on the Brazel ranch was a Mogul balloon, it can certainly exclude it. As soon as those charts are available and the data they contain have been analyzed, Don Schmitt and I will make them public, regardless of the results. Why the Air Force didn't bother to obtain this information is a real puzzle.

However, even without this new information, the conclusion seems self-evident. The debris as described by dozens of witnesses doesn't match Project Mogul balloon arrays, whether it came from Flight 4 or 9. ♦

ENCOUNTER AT BUFF LEDGE

A UFO CASE HISTORY

by
Walter N. Webb



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THE AIR FORCE—*continued from page 5*

with a bunch. Which leads us to wonder what else the Air Force is hiding" (*Albuquerque Tribune*, editorial entitled "Identified Fibbing Object"). Strike one for the Air Force.

As for Rep. Schiff, shortly after the Weaver Report was made public, he told *Albuquerque Tribune* correspondent Karen MacPherson, "[T]hey provide this explanation after insisting over and over, up through last year, that they had no information. . . . [This] will still leave questions in some people's minds about whether we're getting the truth this time. . . . My question about the Air Force report is whether it provides a complete accounting of all [Air Force] records dealing with the Roswell Incident, regardless of their content." In an earlier interview with the same reporter, Schiff said, "The issue is government accountability. The public has a right to know what [its] government is doing." Strike two.

Schiff has also made clear he intends to keep the GAO on the job as long as it takes to be confident that *everything* in the records of the federal government—not just the Air Force—bearing on Roswell has been unearthed and analyzed. And according to reliable sources, the GAO was more than a little irritated by the Air Force public-relations maneuver. Strike three.

THE FOG OF BATTLE

The one area in which the Air Force has had some success with its game plan is in sowing confusion about the role of its report in the overall Congressional-GAO investigation. Based upon my own informal, limited, and far-from-scientific sampling of both the general public and the UFO research-interest community, many people thought the Weaver Report was the final word.

In fact, the report and its attachments are only what the Air Force has chosen to "volunteer" for GAO consideration, in the vain hope the Congressional bloodhounds will be satisfied that is all there is to be found. (Speaking from experience, I can assure you such tactics do *not* work with the GAO.) The material offered by the Air Force will be scrutinized thoroughly, with nothing taken on faith. Moreover, the GAO will pursue its own hands-on review of Air Force records, paying particular attention to such "oversights" as the bodies issue and, it is hoped, the reasons for the Air Force's failure to interview retired Air Force Brig. Gen. Arthur E. Exon.

THE LAST WORD

Above all, it must be kept in mind that the Weaver Report is merely a starting point for the *Air Force segment*—very likely *not* the most important segment—of a continuing, comprehensive GAO audit encompassing the entire national-security establishment, all relevant archival agencies, and perhaps others (such as the Federal Communications

Commission) as well. The GAO audit team has not been sitting around waiting for the Air Force to define the "truth" about Roswell. It has been pursuing its own investigations, laying the groundwork for follow-on activities, assuring access to and cooperation from the other military services and national-security agencies, and establishing its analytical methodologies. The GAO's work continues and will continue for many months to come. We in UFO research must be patient—while continuing to pursue our own independent investigations.

The last word on the Congressional-GAO probe of Roswell has yet to be written. When it is, I think there will be surprises for all of us—especially good Col. Weaver. ♦

AUSTRALIA—*continued from page 9*

3. To encourage health professionals to take an active interest in the topic; to initiate a centralized database on Australian abduction experiences; and to stimulate public debate about the issue.

The response to date to the formation of the network and its associated newsletter has been positive in all quarters. The Australian Abduction Study Center welcomes communications from experiencers, health professionals, and UFO researchers everywhere. ♦

CIRCLES—*continued from page 14*

number of cereologists were undeterred. Since many were souls whose wide eyes already beheld assorted occult visions, this was to be expected. Less expected was the headlong rush of otherwise sensible ufologists in another direction; to them, as committed converts to Terence Meaden's "plasma vortex" theory of circle-formation, the same natural phenomenon that caused crop circles caused UFOs. Before this foolishness had run its course, plasma vortexes had been trumpeted as the final solution to the UFO problem and the true explanation for such classic CE2s as Trans-en-Provence and Rosedale. It should have been obvious then, as it is painfully apparent now, that perceived similarities between crop circles and UFO-related ground traces are coincidental; for one thing, the latter are more varied and usually more dramatic.

So good riddance to crop circles. I'll give them this, though: they did leave us with a wonderfully funny book. ♦

Roswell Declaration

If you haven't signed a copy of the declaration petitioning the government to disclose all facts relating to the Roswell crash, send an SASE to: Roswell Declaration, c/o CUFOS, 2457 W. Peterson, Chicago, IL 60659. We will send you one copy, but feel free to make multiple photocopies for distribution. Return signed declarations to the same address.